

two in a fishing village on the Adriatic. Instead of hitting five Viennese museums a day, you'll spend afternoons writing letters in a café. Instead of going on quickie bus tours the day you arrive, you'll take two or three days to walk around and get the feel of a new city.

The change of pace means your travel needs change. When you dash through Europe on a one-week business trip, you spend only two days in Madrid. You head straight for a \$150-a-night international hotel. The cabdriver knows right where it is. The desk clerk speaks English. Tours of the city start and end there, and you buy the *International Herald Tribune* in the lobby. You've got a phone and color TV in your room.

But when you retire you need less infrastructure—both at home and when you travel. A two-star, \$15-a-night hotel that offers a clean room with bath will do fine. The desk clerk speaks English poorly? Try your Spanish. You're trying to learn it anyway. You need to make an occasional phone call? Ask the clerk to dial the number and talk in the lobby. Or walk over to the phone company's local office and call overseas for a fraction of what you'd pay in a hotel. You'd like to catch a bullfight on TV? Watch it in a bar around the corner.

In 1983 Vicki accompanied me to Rome on a business trip. The first two nights, before the meeting started, we were on our own money. We stayed at the Hotel Piazza di Spagna near the Spanish Steps. The owners run the hotel and chatted happily in broken English while we checked in. We got a room on the third floor with a new, king-size bed. The room had a private bath and cost \$30 a night, including breakfast.

After two pleasant days in the Hotel Piazza di Spagna, on Sunday evening we moved to the "luxury" hotel where the meeting was to be held. We waited in line to check in. When we finally got to the desk, the clerk snarled at us and insisted we leave our passports with him for "processing." I told him it made me nervous to leave my passport on the counter in a